



Philippines



Lying in the western Pacific Ocean, the Philippines is the world's second-largest archipelago, with 7107 islands, of which 4600 are named but only around 1000 inhabited.



GEOGRAPHY

Larger islands are forested and mountainous. Over 20 active volcanoes. Frequent earthquakes.



CLIMATE

Tropical. Warm and humid all year round. Typhoons occur in the rainy season: June–October.



PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Over 100 ethnic groups, most of which are of Malay origin. The Catholic Church is a dominant cultural force; it opposes family-planning, despite high population growth. The Chinese minority has been established for 400 years. Women play a prominent part in society. High literacy levels. Islamist separatists and communist insurgents undermine stability.



INSIGHT: Mass "People Power"

demonstrations have brought down two presidents, in 1986 and 2001



THE ECONOMY

Coconuts, bananas, pineapples exported. Growing outsourcing center. Remittances from abroad. Corruption and poor infrastructure limit growth.



FACTFILE

OFFICIAL NAME: Rep. of the Philippines

DATE OF FORMATION: 1946

CAPITAL: Manila

POPULATION: 92 million

TOTAL AREA: 115,830 sq. km
(300,000 sq. km)

DENSITY: 799 people per sq. mile

LANGUAGES: Filipino*, Tagalog, Cebuano, Hiligaynon, other, including English*

RELIGIONS: Roman Catholic 83%, Protestant 9%, Muslim 5%, other 3%

ETHNIC MIX: Tagalog 28%, Cebuano 13%, Ilocano 9%, Hiligaynon 8%, other 42%

GOVERNMENT: Presidential system

CURRENCY: Philippine peso = 100 centavos